

eigenpal/docx-editor

Project Charter & Contributor Agreement

npm	@eigenpal/docx-js-editor	github	eigenpal/docx-editor
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1. What this is

An open-source WYSIWYG `.docx` editor for React. Drop in `<DocxEditor`
`documentBuffer={file} />` and your users can open, edit, and save Word documents
 entirely in the browser — ~~zero backend required~~no backend required, no document data
 leaving the client.

Most editors serialise to HTML and back: `DOCX → HTML → edits → HTML → DOCX`.
 Every hop loses formatting, tracked changes, and styles. ~~docx-js-editor skips the pipeline-~~
~~entirely~~This library skips it — OOXML is the canonical format throughout.

```
import { DocxEditor } from '@eigenpal/docx-js-editor'
import '@eigenpal/docx-js-editor/styles.css'

function App({ file }: { file: ArrayBuffer }) {
  return (
    <DocxEditor
      documentBuffer={file}
      onSave={(buffer) => uploadToServer(buffer)}
    />
  )
}
```

2. Collaboration — Tracked Changes & Comments

Both features round-trip through OOXML so documents open correctly in Word, LibreOffice, and Google Docs.

Suggestion mode

Toggle between `Editing` and `Suggesting` via the toolbar dropdown. In
 Suggesting mode, every edit becomes a tracked insertion (`green underline`) or deletion (`red strikethrough`). Consecutive keystrokes group into a single change. Accept or reject individually
 or all at once.

Serialises to `w:ins` / `w:del` — the same OOXML markup Word uses.
 Tracked changes survive a save/reload cycle and are reviewable in Word with full accept/reject UI.

Comments

Select text and click the floating button on the page edge to add a comment anchored to that selection. A Google Docs-style sidebar shows threaded cards positioned at their anchor point in the document. Reply, resolve, reopen, or delete inline.

Serialises to `comments.xml` with `w:commentRangeStart` / `w:commentRangeEnd` markers. Comments and reply threads are preserved on round-trip.

Agent-friendly

Because tracked changes and comments are native OOXML, an AI agent can write `w:ins` / `w:del` / `w:comment` markup directly into a document and hand it to `<DocxEditor />` for human review — no custom diff format, no proprietary API.

3. Props

Pass `author="Your App"` to set the author name for comments and tracked changes. Toggle suggestion mode via the toolbar dropdown.

Prop	Type	Default	Description
<code>documentBuffer</code>	<code>ArrayBuffer</code>	—	.docx file contents to load
<code>readOnly</code>	<code>boolean</code>	<code>false</code>	Preview mode — no editing UI
<code>showToolbar</code>	<code>boolean</code>	<code>true</code>	Show formatting toolbar
<code>author</code>	<code>string</code>	<code>'User'</code>	Author name for comments and tracked changes
<code>onChange</code>	<code>function</code>	—	Called on every document change
<code>onSave</code>	<code>function</code>	—	Called on save, receives <code>ArrayBuffer</code>
<code>onError</code>	<code>function</code>	—	Called on error

Ref methods

```
const ref = useRef<DocxEditorRef>(null)

await ref.current.save() // ArrayBuffer of the .docx
ref.current.getDocument() // current document object
ref.current.setZoom(1.5) // set zoom to 150%
ref.current.scrollToPage(3) // scroll to page 3
ref.current.print() // print
```

4. Contributing

Read <docs/PLUGINS.md> before opening a pull request that touches the plugin API.

Ground rules

- Every PR must pass the round-trip test: load a .docx, apply an edit, export, reload — content and formatting must be stable on unchanged content.
- Run `bun test` and `bun run test:e2e` locally before pushing.
- ~~Do not introduce intermediate HTML serialisation. This is a hard constraint.~~ Avoid intermediate HTML serialisation where possible.
- Tracked changes and comments must survive a full OOXML round-trip — save, open in Word, verify changes are reviewable, reload in the editor.

Dev setup

```
bun install
bun run dev // Vite demo on localhost:5173
```

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Most editors serialise to HTML and back: `DOCX → HTML → edits → HTML → DOCX`. Every hop loses formatting, tracked changes, and styles. docx-js-editor skips the pipeline entirely. This library skips it — OOXML is the canonical format throughout.

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